

ETIS

Student User Guide

Complete student reference: sign-in, team/repository setup, evidence, frozen checkpoints, reviews, engineering decisions, history, and troubleshooting

v0.18.0 release manual edition. Production acceptance has separate source and deployment provenance.

Audience	Students in COMP 330/474 and other approved ETIS course sections
Purpose	Explain the complete student experience from first sign-in through repeated evidence-based engineering reviews and historical learning records.
Reference implementation	COMP 330/474 Software Engineering • Fall 2026
Version	v0.18.0 • October 2, 2026

CORE PRINCIPLE

The Studio can challenge, coach, explain, and ask for evidence. You remain the responsible engineer. You may disagree with the reviewer, admit uncertainty, and change your position when the evidence changes.

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Use Word's Navigation pane to jump directly among the numbered headings. The section list below follows the same structure.

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Executive Overview

ETIS Engineering Studio is an engineering apprenticeship environment. It uses your team's real repository evidence to create senior-review-style conversations. The goal is not to satisfy an AI reviewer. The goal is to practice making decisions that are evidence-based, explicit about uncertainty and consequences, and defensible to other engineers.

What you should be able to do

- Sign in using Loyola Microsoft identity and confirm the correct course/team context.
- Link the GitHub identity you actually use for engineering work.
- Establish one verified team repository through the controlled GitHub App process.
- Understand what the Studio can and cannot see in the current phase.
- Use Board Review, Focused Review, or Review Findings for the right purpose.
- Ask questions, challenge the reviewer, state uncertainty, and own your engineering position.
- Understand how frozen evidence checkpoints relate to commits and later repository changes.
- Revisit old reviews without rewriting the evidence or reasoning that existed at that time.

Normal student path

Sign in	Confirm team	Link GitHub	Verify repository	Inspect evidence	Start review	Reason & decide	Revisit history
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WHAT THIS IS NOT

The Studio is not the course submission system, not an automated grader, not a replacement for GitHub, and not an AI oracle. Sakai remains authoritative for official course requirements and deadlines. GitHub remains the source of your team's working repository history.

ABOUT THE SCREENSHOTS

Embedded screenshots are historical August 2026 examples. They illustrate workflow states; labels/layout may differ from v0.18.0. Current instructions and source contracts govern behavior. No screenshot is proof of this release's deployment acceptance.

2. How ETIS fits with Sakai, GitHub, and your engineering work

System	What it is for	What it is not
Sakai	Official course announcements, deadlines, assignment instructions, and course control.	Not the engineering review room.
GitHub	Your actual working repository, commits, branches, pull requests, issues, Actions, tags, and team engineering activity.	Not automatically trusted by ETIS until the team repository is verified.
ETIS Engineering Studio	Developmental engineering judgment practice using frozen repository evidence and bounded senior-review coaching.	Not the formal grading authority and not a replacement for the responsible engineer.

System	What it is for	What it is not
ETIS Preflight	Readiness check near a formal phase-gate review.	Not the Studio and not the formal review itself.
ETIS Engineering Review Center	Instructor-facing formal phase-gate review against designated evidence boundaries.	Not a continuation of a student Studio conversation by default.

WHY THE BOUNDARIES MATTER

A Studio conversation is developmental. It can influence what your team chooses to change, but the conversation itself does not silently become formal phase-gate evidence. Formal review is grounded in the designated repository evidence boundary.

3. First sign-in and navigation

3.1 Sign in with Loyola

1. Open <https://simulator.etisframework.org>.
2. Choose Sign in with Loyola.
3. Complete normal Loyola Microsoft sign-in and Loyola MFA if your account requires it.
4. ETIS checks course/section authorization after identity verification; authentication alone does not create course access.

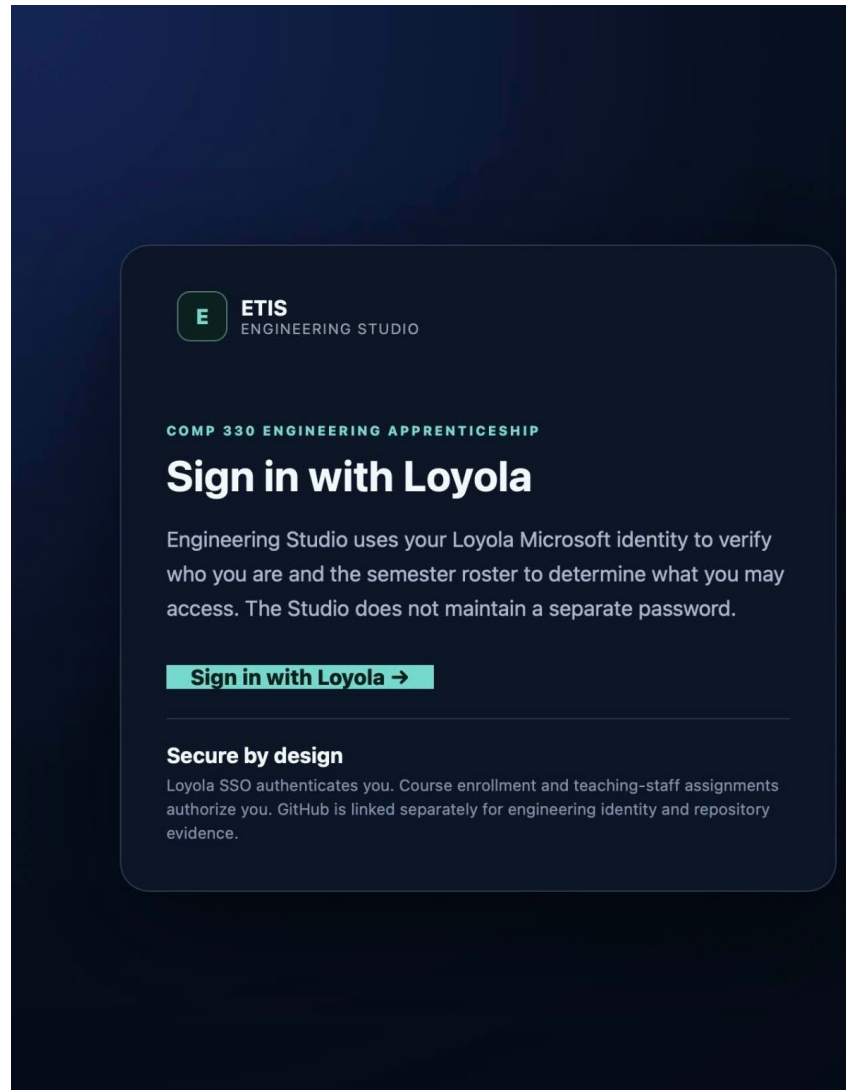


Figure 1. Loyola sign-in gate. ETIS does not maintain a separate student password. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

3.2 Main student navigation

Area	Use it for
Engineering Studio	Choose/start a review, see phase context, work in the Review Room, and continue an active session.
Engineering Evidence	See strengths, current-phase evidence, professional lenses, findings, coverage, and paths into review.
Review History	Revisit prior sessions and see how your engineering judgment changed over time.
My Team	Confirm team membership, GitHub identity, project details, and verified repository state.
Help & guidance	Open Studio guidance for how to engage reviewers and own the judgment.

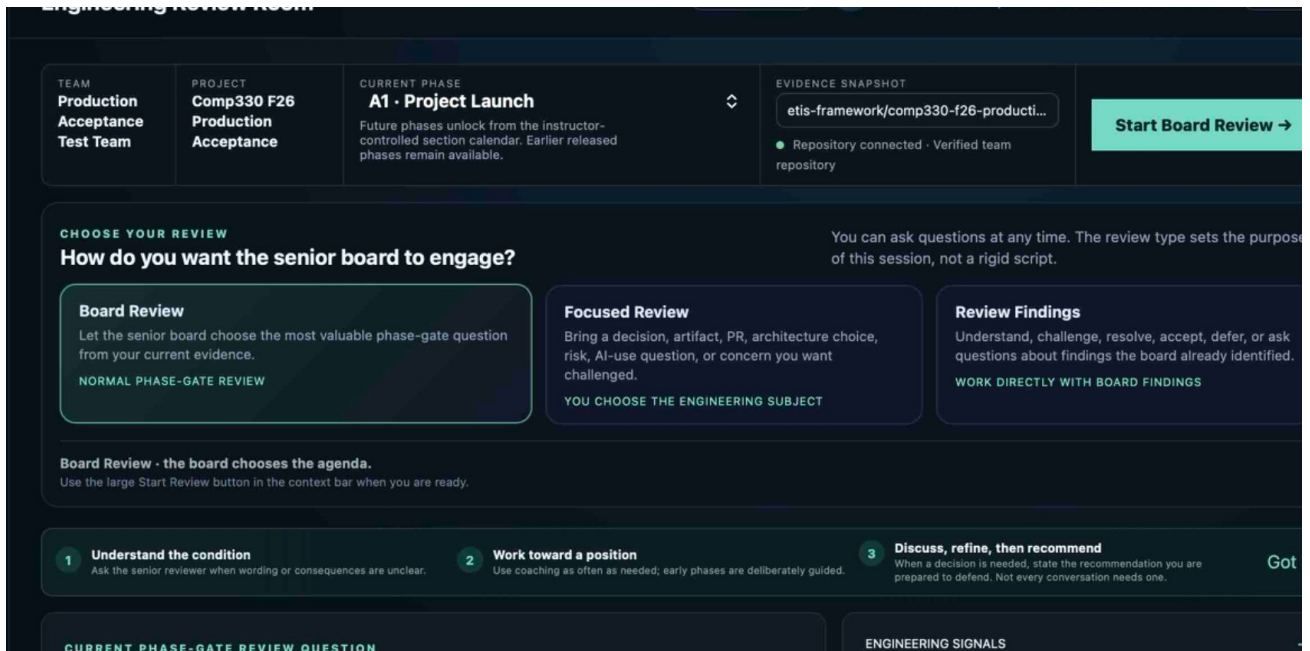


Figure 2. The Studio context bar shows team, project, current phase, evidence snapshot context, and the review-start action. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

BROWSER BACK/FORWARD

Meaningful Studio navigation preserves relevant section/team/review context. Do not rely on an old tab to prove access; the server reevaluates current authorization for protected actions.

4. My Team, GitHub identity, and repository trust

My Team separates four conditions that students often confuse: Loyola identity, course/team assignment, GitHub identity, and verified repository access. All four can be healthy independently or fail independently.

Condition	Meaning
Loyola identity verified	ETIS knows who you are through Microsoft Entra.
COMP 330 team assigned	The course roster/team model authorizes your student context.
GitHub identity linked	ETIS knows which GitHub account represents you as an engineer. The OAuth access token is not retained for repository reading.
Verified team repository	The exact team repository has been verified through the GitHub App and becomes team-wide trusted evidence.

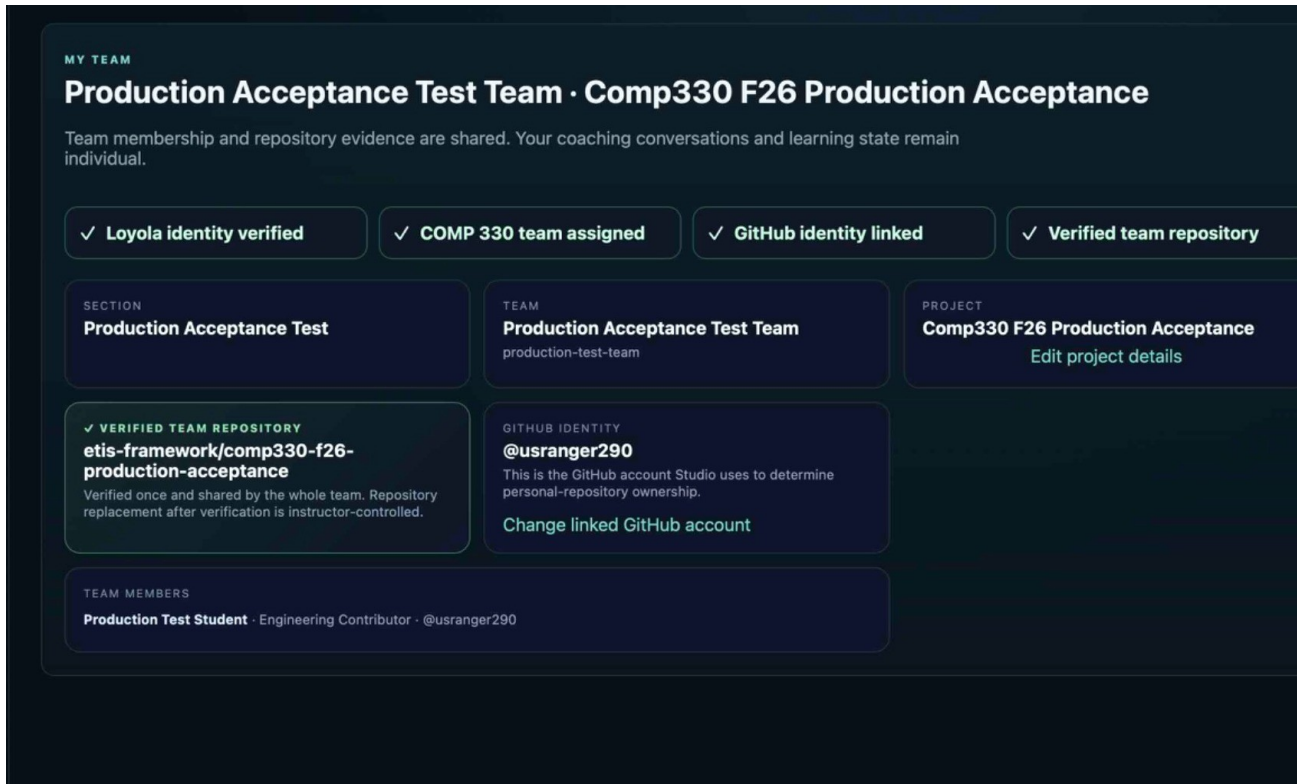


Figure 3. Healthy My Team state: identity, team, GitHub link, and verified team repository are all established. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

4.1 Changing your linked GitHub account

Use Change linked GitHub account when you linked the wrong GitHub identity or need ETIS to associate you with the account you actually use. Changing your personal GitHub identity does not silently replace the team's verified repository.

TEAM-SHARED VS. INDIVIDUAL

Repository binding, team membership, and repository evidence are team-shared. Your coaching conversations, recommendation development, and learning history are individual. One teammate verifying the repository does not merge everyone's review conversations.

5. Repository setup: normal, personal, and organization cases

Controlled repository trust flow

Nominate URL	Owner/admin authorizes App	Return to ETIS	Verify exact repository	Team-wide verified state
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5.1 Nominate the working repository

1. In My Team, paste the HTTPS URL for the team's actual working GitHub repository. The .git suffix is optional.
2. Check the owner and repository name carefully. A pasted URL is only a candidate; ETIS will not use it as trusted review evidence yet.
3. Choose Nominate team repository.

MY TEAM

Production Acceptance Test Team · Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance

Team membership and repository evidence are shared. Your coaching conversations and learning state remain individual.

✓ Loyola identity verified

✓ COMP 330 team assigned

✓ GitHub identity linked

○ Verified team repository

SECTION
Production Acceptance Test

TEAM
Production Acceptance Test Team
production-test-team

PROJECT
Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance
[Edit project details](#)

SETUP REQUIRED · TEAM REPOSITORY

Next step: nominate the team's actual working repository

Any teammate may nominate it. Studio will not use the repository as review evidence until ownership and ETIS access are verified.

HTTPS GitHub repository URL

Use your team's actual working repository. The .git suffix is optional. Example: `https://github.com/organization/team-repository`

`https://github.com/organization/team-repository`

Paste a complete `https://github.com/owner/repository` URL to continue.

Nominate team repository →

GITHUB IDENTITY

@usranger290

This is the GitHub account Studio uses to determine personal-repository ownership.

[Change linked GitHub account](#)

TEAM MEMBERS

Production Test Student · Engineering Contributor · @usranger290

Figure 4. Nominate the team's actual working repository. The URL is a candidate until exact access is verified. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

5.2 Step 1 - repository owner/organization authorization

GitHub, not ETIS, decides whether your account can install the App directly or whether an organization owner/admin must approve the request.

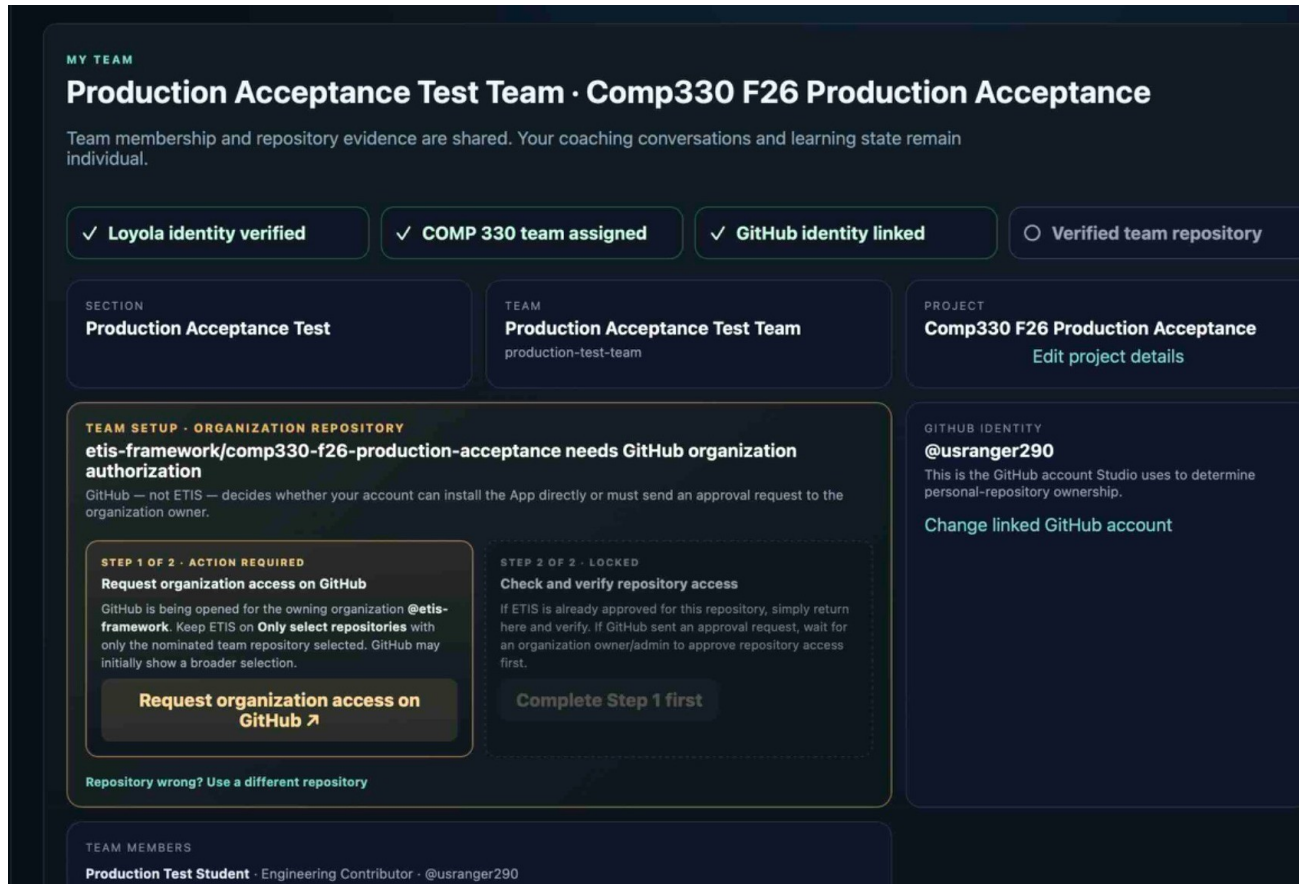


Figure 5. Organization repository onboarding before Step 1. Step 2 remains locked until GitHub authorization is opened/completed. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

Repository ownership	Who must act	Student behavior
Personal repository	The actual personal-repository owner.	A non-owning teammate should wait for the owner rather than attempting to take over repository authorization.
Organization repository	GitHub organization owner/admin if GitHub requires approval.	Follow the GitHub request/approval flow. Do not describe this automatically as instructor approval unless the instructor actually has organization authority.

5.3 On GitHub: Only select repositories

- Select Only select repositories.
- Select the nominated team repository and no unrelated repositories.
- Do not choose All repositories. ETIS intentionally fails closed on all-repository installation scope.
- Do not use personal access tokens (PATs) for ETIS repository evidence access.

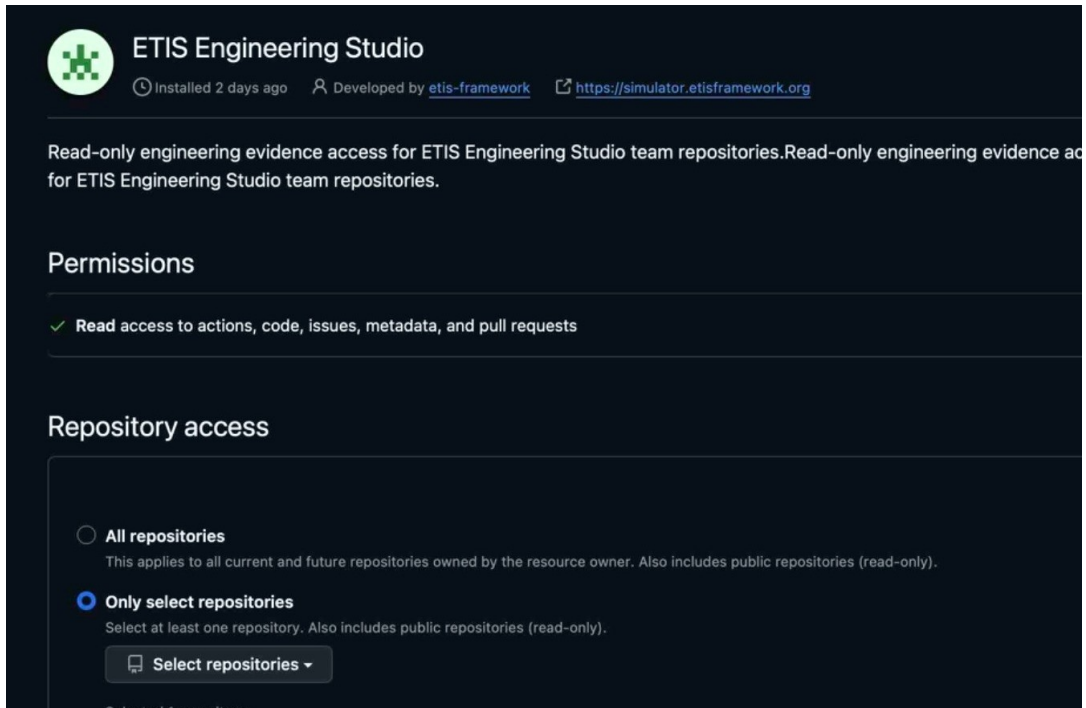


Figure 6. GitHub App repository-access screen. Choose Only select repositories, then choose only the repository nominated in My Team. The example intentionally crops out a repository name because your team repository will differ. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

STOP AND CHECK BEFORE SAVING

The important security decision on this GitHub page is scope: Only select repositories must be selected. The repository chooser should contain the same repository you nominated in My Team - not another class project, personal repository, or all repositories.

5.4 Step 2 - verify the exact repository

After GitHub authorization or organization approval, return to My Team and use Check & verify repository access. Authorization alone is not enough. ETIS requests short-lived access scoped to the nominated repository and verifies the exact repository before promoting it to trusted team evidence.

MY TEAM

Production Acceptance Test Team · Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance

Team membership and repository evidence are shared. Your coaching conversations and learning state remain individual.

✓ Loyola identity verified

✓ COMP 330 team assigned

✓ GitHub identity linked

○ Verified team repository

SECTION

Production Acceptance Test

TEAM

Production Acceptance Test Team
production-test-team

PROJECT

Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance
[Edit project details](#)

TEAM SETUP · ORGANIZATION REPOSITORY

etis-framework/comp330-f26-production-acceptance needs GitHub organization authorization

GitHub — not ETIS — decides whether your account can install the App directly or must send an approval request to the organization owner.

STEP 1 OF 2 · OPENED ✓

GitHub organization access requested/opened

GitHub is being opened for the owning organization **@etis-framework**. Keep ETIS on **Only select repositories** with only the nominated team repository selected. GitHub may initially show a broader selection.

Open GitHub request again ↗

STEP 2 OF 2 · ACTION REQUIRED

Check and verify repository access

If ETIS is already approved for this repository, simply return here and verify. If GitHub sent an approval request, wait for an organization owner/admin to approve repository access first.

Check & verify repository access →

Repository wrong? Use a different repository

GITHUB IDENTITY

@usranger290

This is the GitHub account Studio uses to determine personal-repository ownership.

Change linked GitHub account

TEAM MEMBERS

Production Test Student · Engineering Contributor · @usranger290

Figure 7. Step 1 is complete, but the repository is not trusted until Step 2 verifies exact access. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

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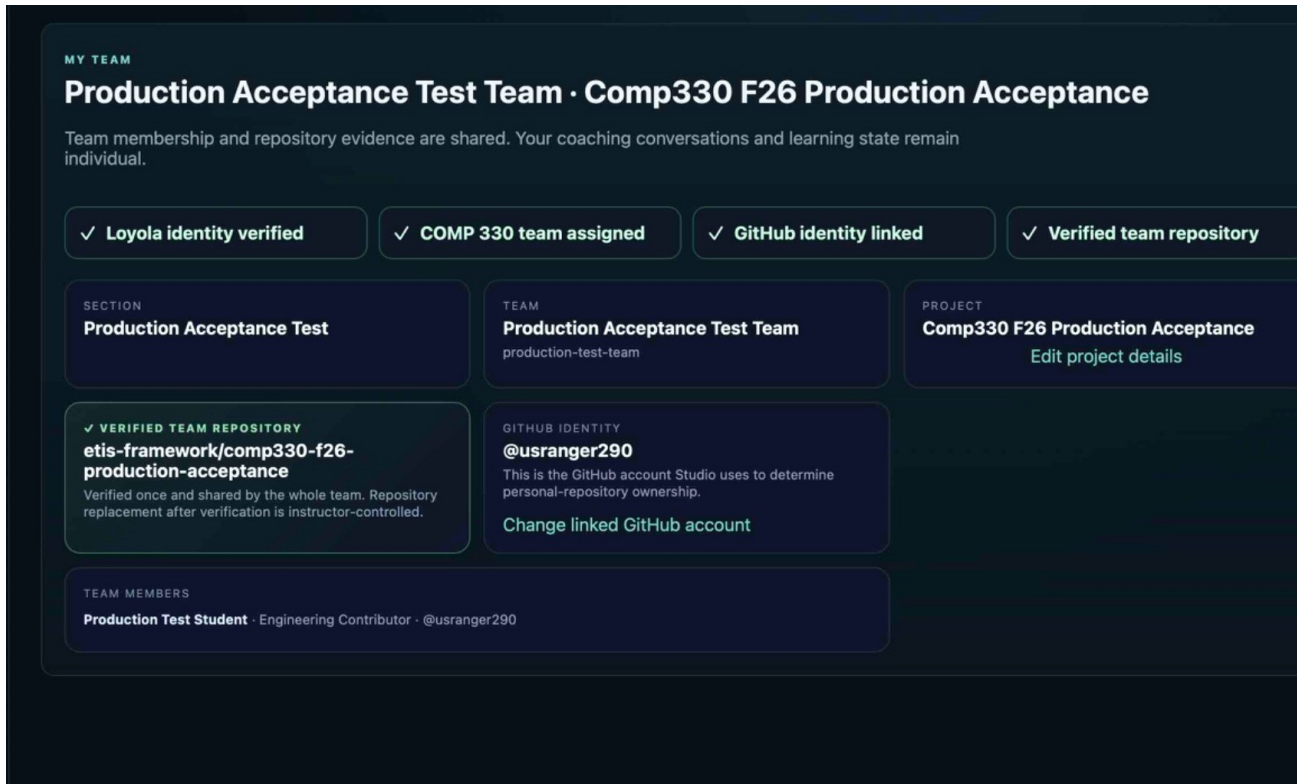


Figure 8. Verified team repository. Once verified, the repository connection is shared by the team. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

IF THE REPOSITORY IS WRONG

Before verification, use the “Repository wrong? Use a different repository” path. After verification, students cannot directly replace the trusted repository; an Instructor/Course Owner reset is required so the normal trust process can begin again.

6. Evidence, commit history, and frozen checkpoints

6.1 The central idea: a review uses a frozen checkpoint

Your GitHub repository keeps changing as the team works. A useful review cannot move underneath you. When you start a review, the Studio freezes the repository evidence state used by that session. The UI calls this a frozen evidence snapshot. You can think of it as the review checkpoint.

Checkpoint lifecycle

Working GitHub repository	Start review	Freeze evidence snapshot	Review uses that snapshot	Team keeps working	Later review freezes a newer snapshot
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Question	Answer
Do I press a separate “checkpoint” button?	No. In the current student experience, beginning a review freezes the current evidence snapshot automatically.

Question	Answer
Does a later commit change an active/completed review?	No. The old review remains tied to its original frozen evidence.
Can the team keep committing while I review?	Yes. New GitHub work does not rewrite the evidence already frozen for that session.
How do later changes become reviewable?	Start a later review so the Studio can analyze/freeze a newer repository state.
Where is exact Git commit history?	GitHub remains the authoritative commit-history browser. ETIS can analyze commit/workflow history as engineering evidence, but the current student UI is not a full replacement for GitHub's commit browser.

COMMIT HISTORY VS. REVIEW HISTORY

Commit history answers “what changed in the repository?” in GitHub. Review History answers “what did I reason about, against which frozen evidence, and how did my position develop?” in ETIS. They are related but not the same record.

6.2 Snapshot identifiers and evidence context

Engineering Evidence displays the current evidence context and a short snapshot identifier. The Review Room also shows that the evidence is Frozen. Treat these identifiers as provenance: they help distinguish the repository state used by one review from a later review after the team has changed the repository.

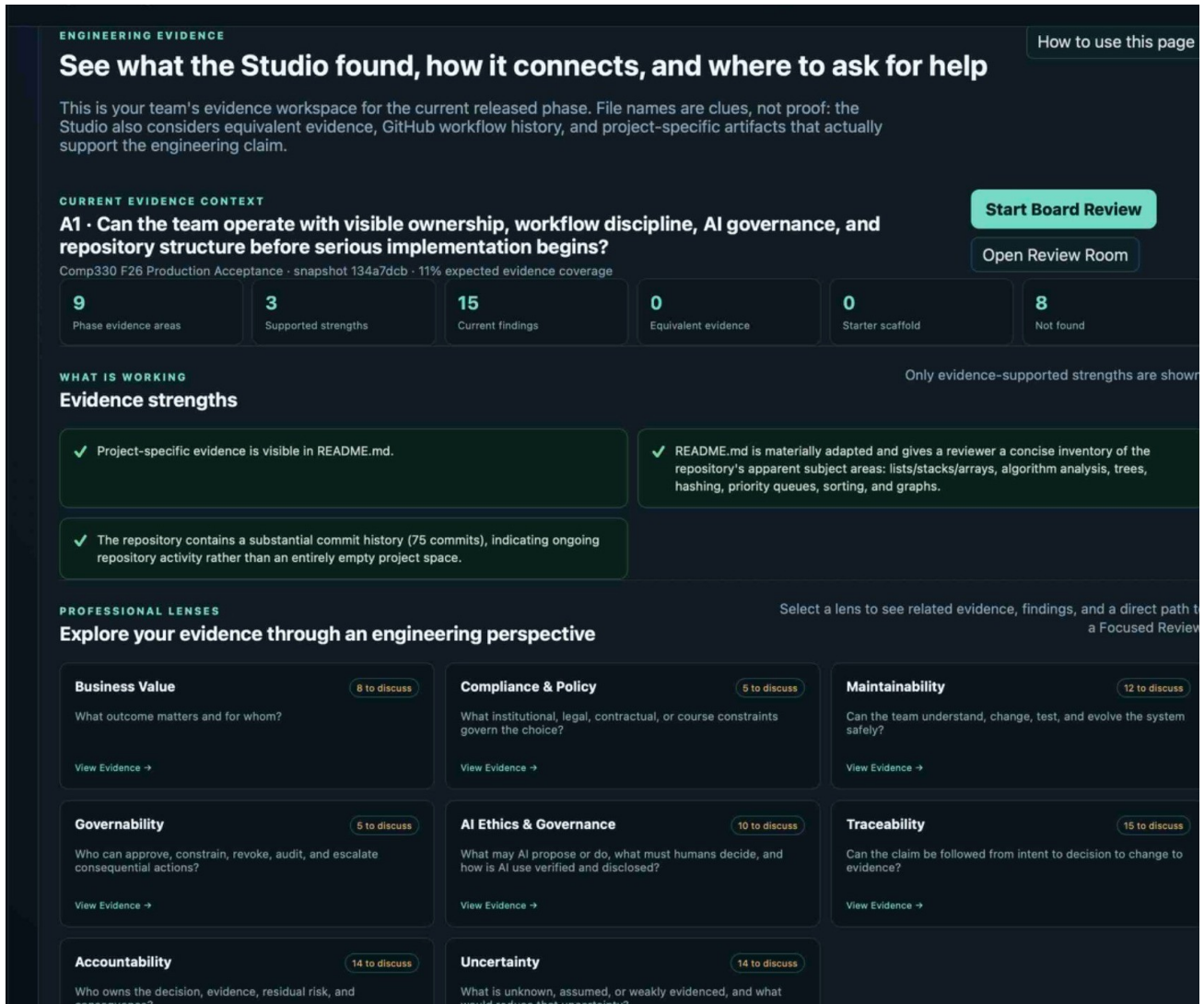


Figure 9. Engineering Evidence shows the current phase, snapshot identifier, strengths, findings, and evidence lenses. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

7. Engineering Evidence workspace

Engineering Evidence is where you inspect what the Studio found before or during a review. It is phase-aware: it emphasizes the current released phase and distinguishes actual team evidence from unchanged starter scaffold.

Element	How to read it
Phase evidence areas	Evidence categories expected or relevant for the current phase.
Supported strengths	Evidence-backed things the team is already doing defensibly.
Current findings	REVIEW interpretations/questions worth examining. They are not immutable facts.
Equivalent evidence	Project-specific artifacts that satisfy the engineering purpose even if they use a different form/name.

Element	How to read it
Starter scaffold	Unchanged starter-kit material. Useful structure, but not evidence that your team actually performed the work.
Not found	Expected/equivalent evidence was not visible in the frozen snapshot.
Professional lenses	Ways to inspect evidence through business value, policy, maintainability, governance, AI ethics, traceability, accountability, uncertainty, and other engineering concerns.

7.1 Reading common evidence labels

Label	Student interpretation
FACT	Repository-derived evidence frozen into the current review context.
REVIEW	A Studio interpretation or finding derived from FACT evidence; it may be challenged or corrected.
CURRENT PHASE	Relevant to the phase currently released by the instructor.
TEAM ADAPTED	Starter/template material has been materially adapted into team-specific evidence.
SCAFFOLD / BASELINE	Provided starter structure; useful context but not proof that your team completed the work.
OPEN / WEAK	A finding or evidence area still needs engineering attention; it is not an automatic grade.

ENGINEERING EVIDENCE

How to use this page

See what the Studio found, how it connects, and where to ask for help

This is your team's evidence workspace for the current released phase. File names are clues, not proof: the Studio also considers equivalent evidence, GitHub workflow history, and project-specific artifacts that actually support the engineering claim.

CURRENT EVIDENCE CONTEXT

A1 · Can the team operate with visible ownership, workflow discipline, AI governance, and repository structure before serious implementation begins?

Start Board Review

Open Review Room

Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance · snapshot 134a7dcb · 11% expected evidence coverage

9 Phase evidence areas	3 Supported strengths	15 Current findings	0 Equivalent evidence	0 Starter scaffold	8 Not found
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WHAT IS WORKING

Only evidence-supported strengths are shown

Evidence strengths

✓ Project-specific evidence is visible in README.md.

✓ README.md is materially adapted and gives a reviewer a concise inventory of the repository's apparent subject areas: lists/stacks/arrays, algorithm analysis, trees, hashing, priority queues, sorting, and graphs.

✓ The repository contains a substantial commit history (75 commits), indicating ongoing repository activity rather than an entirely empty project space.

PROFESSIONAL LENSES

Select a lens to see related evidence, findings, and a direct path to a Focused Review

Explore your evidence through an engineering perspective

Business Value 8 to discuss What outcome matters and for whom? View Evidence →	Compliance & Policy 5 to discuss What institutional, legal, contractual, or course constraints govern the choice? View Evidence →	Maintainability 12 to discuss Can the team understand, change, test, and evolve the system safely? View Evidence →
Governability 5 to discuss Who can approve, constrain, revoke, audit, and escalate consequential actions? View Evidence →	AI Ethics & Governance 10 to discuss What may AI propose or do, what must humans decide, and how is AI use verified and disclosed? View Evidence →	Traceability 15 to discuss Can the claim be followed from intent to decision to change to evidence? View Evidence →
Accountability 14 to discuss Who owns the decision, evidence, residual risk, and consequence? View Evidence →	Uncertainty 14 to discuss What is unknown, assumed, or weakly evidenced, and what would reduce that uncertainty? View Evidence →	

Figure 10. Evidence strengths and professional lenses help you start with what is working, then choose where deeper reasoning is useful. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

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Engineering Evidence

REVIEW **OPEN** RESPECT ASK THE GROUP

CURRENT FINDINGS Findings are REVIEW interpretations, not immutable facts. Ask challenge, resolve, accept, or defer them

Questions or concerns worth examining

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/team/team-charter.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/team/team-charter.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/team/roles.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/team/roles.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/team/working-agreements.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/team/working-agreements.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/ai/ai-policy.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/ai/ai-policy.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/ai/ai-use-log.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/ai/ai-use-log.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/requirements/

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/requirements/' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/planning/

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/planning/' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

Expected evidence not visible: docs/decisions/

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/decisions/' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

No team issue workflow is visible yet

No GitHub Issues were visible in the reviewed repository state.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

README describes course modules, not the A1 project direction

The supplied README identifies the repository as a CS272/COMP 272 collection of data-structures-and-algorithms modules, but it does not establish a project goal, current direction, bounded Cycle 1 vertical slice, assumptions, acceptance intent, or an evidence map for COMP 330 A1.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this Open evidence ↗

REVIEW OPEN

No supplied evidence of team operating agreements or credible ownership

No supplied artifact establishes team purpose, cadence, communication norms, conflict handling, definition of done, student-to-GitHub identity mapping, primary/backup ownership, or acknowledgements.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

AI-use policy and verification trail are absent from the supplied evidence

No supplied artifact defines acceptable and unacceptable AI use, disclosure requirements, human ownership, verification expectations, or a log of meaningful AI assistance.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

REVIEW OPEN

No visible A1 planning, requirements, or decision record

The supplied evidence contains no requirements, planning, risk, estimate, schedule, traceability, or durable decision artifacts identifying initial scope, explicit out-of-scope boundaries, implementation-entry criteria, or the reasoning behind consequential choices.

REVIEW OPEN

Repository activity does not evidence meaningful review before merge

The supplied GitHub metrics show zero pull requests, zero issues, no protected branch, and one branch. The recent activity is dominated by direct uploads and updates, so the evidence does not demonstrate review criteria, review participation, or merge control.

Figure 11. Findings are REVIEW interpretations. Use Discuss, Challenge, or Help me resolve this instead of treating them as unquestionable facts. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

0% OR LOW COVERAGE

Low coverage does not necessarily mean GitHub is disconnected or the repository is empty. Starter-kit scaffold is intentionally not counted as completed team evidence, and project-specific equivalent evidence may need to be recognized or discussed.

START VS. OPEN REVIEW ROOM

If no review is active, the Evidence workspace can offer a Start Board Review path. If you already have an active review, use Open Review Room to return to that conversation instead of starting a duplicate session just to see the same frozen evidence.

Moving between the two rooms

The Review Room is the conversation home. Engineering Evidence is the saved source notebook. Same-snapshot and newer-saved-snapshot notices explain their relationship; browsing newer saved evidence never changes an active review's frozen baseline.

Inspect cited source opens the attached frozen artifact. Find supporting evidence searches the frozen snapshot for equivalent evidence; it is bounded and not exhaustive. Discuss helps you understand, Challenge tests an interpretation, and Help me resolve this coaches next work. An absent source must not be replaced by a guessed file link.

Keep a newer saved snapshot separate from your active review. If a finding belongs to another snapshot, return to the matching review or start an appropriate new review; do not expect a search to blend the two snapshots.

8. Choosing the right review type

Review	Use it when	Who sets the agenda
Board Review	You want the normal phase-gate developmental review using the most valuable challenge in the current evidence.	The senior board chooses the highest-value current challenge.
Focused Review	You want candid coaching on a specific artifact, decision, pull request, architecture choice, risk, AI-use question, or work-in-progress concern.	You name the engineering subject.
Review Findings	You want to understand, challenge, resolve, accept/defer, or provide contrary evidence for existing findings.	You select one to three related findings so the session remains coherent.

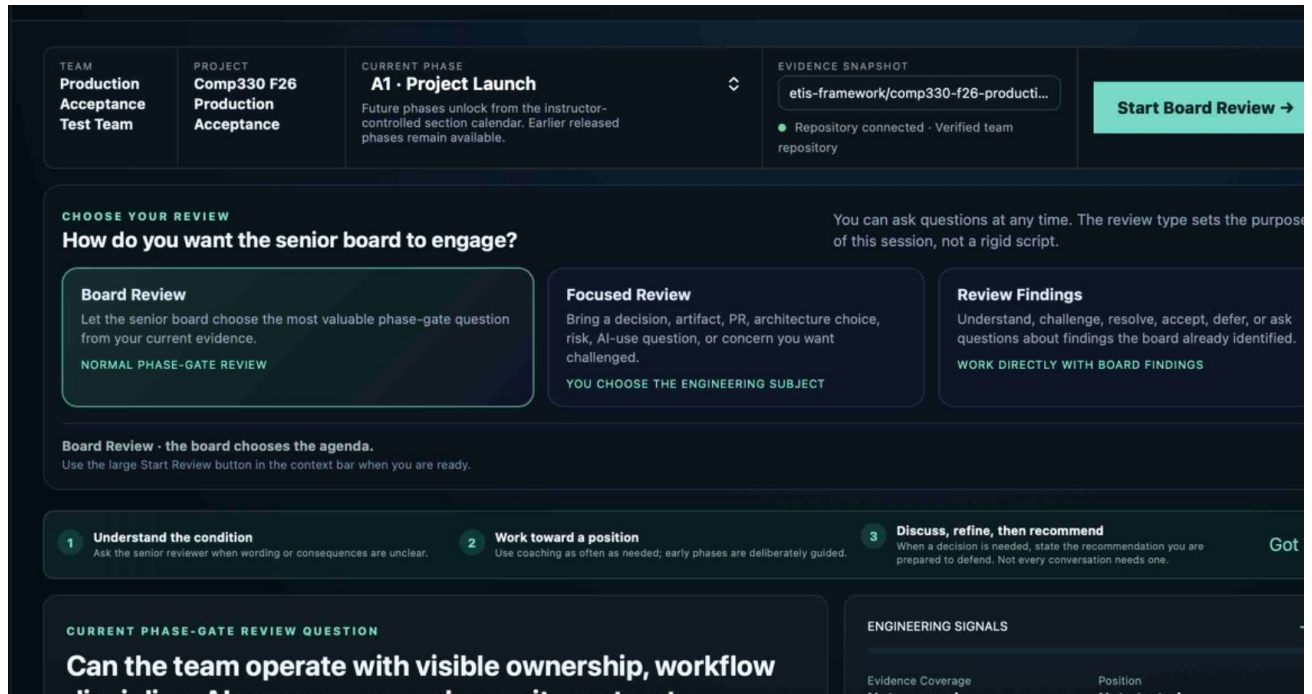


Figure 12. The three review types. Choose the purpose before starting; the type stays locked for that session. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

9. Starting Board, Focused, and Review Findings sessions

9.1 Board Review

1. Choose Board Review.
2. Read the current phase-gate review question and engineering signals.
3. Choose Start Board Review.
4. The Studio binds the review to the current frozen phase snapshot (reusing the same commit and phase when unchanged), and the board selects a high-value concern.

Can the team operate with visible ownership, workflow discipline, AI governance, and repository structure before serious implementation begins?

This is the standing A1 phase-gate review question. The board will evaluate it using your team's actual repository evidence.

Think like a junior engineer in a review with senior engineers. You are expected to make the decision, but the board will coach you until the reasoning is strong enough to own.

Business Value Evidence Accountability AI Governance Uncertainty

Evidence Coverage
0% team evidence

Reasoning Moves
1 move at a time

Signals help you navigate the review. They are not an autonomous course grade.

Position
In discussion

Instructor Visibility
On

SENIOR REVIEW BOARD

AI use policy and disclosure are absent as team evidence

Maya - Evidence Marcus - Architecture Elena - Red Team Priya - Delivery

Finding review in progress Session #4 · A1 · etis-framework/comp330-f26-production-acceptance@e973c03a · evidence analysis reused **Complete Review**

CURRENTLY COACHING YOU
Elena Torres · Red Team Reviewer
Failure modes · Assumptions · Residual risk

WHAT THE BOARD NOTICED

docs/ai/ai-policy.md, docs/ai/ai-use-log.md, and docs/ai/ai-verification-notes.md are unchanged scaffold. The empty log contains no tool, purpose, artifact, human verification, or resulting action, and the policy does not define permitted use, prohibited use, disclosure expectations, or human ownership.

WHY IT MATTERS

A reviewer cannot determine whether AI-assisted work is acceptable or how accepted output would be made trustworthy and attributable.

YOUR ENGINEERING DECISION

What should the team do now, given what the repository evidence actually supports?

WHAT THE BOARD FOUND WORKING

- The official COMP 330 engineering scaffold is present, giving the team a consistent evidence structure to build from.
- The repository establishes the expected documentation areas for requirements, planning, decisions, team operations, and AI governance, giving the project a discoverable evidence structure.
- The starter materials explicitly distinguish scaffold from project-specific engineering evidence and require traceability, verification, and risk documentation in CONTRIBUTING.md.
- The pull-request template includes useful intended prompts for motivation, verification, evidence, risk, and follow-up, although no project PR demonstrates that the process was used.

ELENA TORRES · RED TEAM REVIEWER opening challenge

Production, One thing the team has going for it: The official COMP 330 engineering scaffold is present, giving the team a consistent evidence structure to build from. Now I want to examine one A1 concern: docs/ai/ai-policy.md, docs/ai/ai-use-log.md, and docs/ai/ai-verification-notes.md are unchanged scaffold. The empty log contains no tool, purpose, artifact, human verification, or

EVIDENCE RAIL

What the board can see

0 Team evidence **9** Needs review **Frozen** Snapshot

EV-001 **README.md** **WEAK**
A reviewer can understand the project, current direction, and evidence map.
FACT **TEAM ADAPTED** **CURRENT PHASE**
A1 expected evidence
[Ask about this](#) [Reference](#) [Open](#)

EV-002 **docs/team/team-charter.md** **SCAFFOLD**
Team purpose, cadence, expectations, and operating rhythm are explicit.
FACT **BASELINE** **CURRENT PHASE**
A1 expected evidence
[Ask about this](#) [Reference](#) [Open](#)

EV-003 **docs/team/roles.md** **SCAFFOLD**
Student identities, GitHub identities, primary/backup ownership, and acknowledgements are explicit.

RELATED GUIDANCE
Contextual references, not required answers
Relevant ETIS and reference guidance will appear here when useful.

REVIEW FINDINGS
Snapshot-bound findings · ask, challenge, resolve, or defer

Evidence may be too thin:
README.md **REVIEW** **OPEN**
"README.md" exists but appears incomplete or still scaffold-like.

Figure 13. Before the review starts, the evidence rail explains that beginning the review freezes the current evidence snapshot. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

9.2 Focused Review

1. Choose Focused Review.
2. In “What should the board focus on?”, name the actual engineering subject - for example authentication architecture, a PR, a database choice, a risk register, or an AI verification concern.
3. Start the review. Bring the relevant decision/evidence into the conversation instead of asking for generic approval.

TEAM
Production Acceptance Test Team

PROJECT
Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance

CURRENT PHASE
A1 - Project Launch
Future phases unlock from the instructor-controlled section calendar. Earlier released phases remain available.

EVIDENCE SNAPSHOT
etis-framework/comp330-f26-producti...
Repository connected - Verified team repository

Start Focused Review →

CHOOSE YOUR REVIEW
How do you want the senior board to engage?

Board Review
Let the senior board choose the most valuable phase-gate question from your current evidence.
NORMAL PHASE-GATE REVIEW

Focused Review
Bring a decision, artifact, PR, architecture choice, risk, AI-use question, or concern you want challenged.
YOU CHOOSE THE ENGINEERING SUBJECT

Review Findings
Understand, challenge, resolve, accept, defer, or ask questions about findings the board already identified.
WORK DIRECTLY WITH BOARD FINDINGS

You can ask questions at any time. The review type sets the purpose of this session, not a rigid script.

What should the board focus on?
Examples: authentication architecture, our risk register, PR #27, database choice, AI verification

Focused Review - you choose the engineering subject.
Use the large Start Review button in the context bar when you are ready.

1 Understand the condition
Ask the senior reviewer when wording or consequences are unclear.

2 Work toward a position
Use coaching as often as needed; early phases are deliberately guided.

3 Discuss, refine, then recommend
When a decision is needed, state the recommendation you are prepared to defend. Not every conversation needs one.

Got

Figure 14. Focused Review lets you choose the engineering subject while keeping the same phase/evidence context. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

9.3 Review Findings

1. Choose Review Findings.
2. Select up to three related findings.
3. Start the finding review.
4. Ask what the finding means, challenge it, provide contrary evidence, accept/defer it, or work toward resolution.

TEAM

Production Acceptance Test Team

PROJECT

Comp330 F26 Production Acceptance

CURRENT PHASE

A1 - Project Launch

Future phases unlock from the instructor-controlled section calendar. Earlier released phases remain available.

EVIDENCE SNAPSHOT

etis-framework/comp330-f26-producti...

Repository connected - Verified team repository

Start Finding Review →

CHOOSE YOUR REVIEW

How do you want the senior board to engage?

Board Review

Let the senior board choose the most valuable phase-gate question from your current evidence.

NORMAL PHASE-GATE REVIEW

Focused Review

Bring a decision, artifact, PR, architecture choice, risk, AI-use question, or concern you want challenged.

YOU CHOOSE THE ENGINEERING SUBJECT

Review Findings

Understand, challenge, resolve, accept, defer, or ask questions about findings the board already identified.

WORK DIRECTLY WITH BOARD FINDINGS

Select up to three related findings

The board keeps this session coherent rather than trying to solve everything at once.

☒ Expected evidence not visible: docs/team/team-charter.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/team/team-charter.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

☐ Expected evidence not visible: docs/team/working-agreements.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/team/working-agreements.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

☐ Expected evidence not visible: docs/team/roles.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/team/roles.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

☐ Expected evidence not visible: docs/ai/ai-policy.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/ai/ai-policy.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

☐ Expected evidence not visible: docs/ai/ai-use-log.md

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/ai/ai-use-log.md' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

☐ Expected evidence not visible: docs/requirements/

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/requirements/' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

☐ Expected evidence not visible: docs/planning/

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/planning/' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

☐ Expected evidence not visible: docs/decisions/

The snapshot did not contain 'docs/decisions/' or an equivalent artifact detected in that evidence area.

Review Findings - 1 selected.

Use the large Start Review button in the context bar when you are ready.

Figure 15. Review Findings limits the session to a small related set so the conversation stays coherent. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

10. Working in the Engineering Review Room

The Review Room is designed as an apprenticeship conversation, not a quiz. The reviewer may be demanding, but you can ask questions, disagree, or say that you do not know yet. Productive struggle can turn into more direct teaching when you use the coaching controls.

Area	What it does
Senior Review Board	Shows the challenge and the active professional reviewer/lens.
What the board noticed	Summarizes the evidence/problem the reviewer is reacting to.
Why it matters	Connects the evidence to engineering consequences.
Your engineering decision	Frames what you, as the engineer, must decide or investigate.
Evidence rail	Shows frozen evidence, related guidance, and review findings that remain bound to the snapshot.
Talk to reviewer	Normal conversational response. Ask, answer, disagree, or think aloud.

Area	What it does
Give me a nudge	Requests a reframe/scaffold when stuck. The system should teach without silently deciding for you.
Build my recommendation	Shifts coaching toward a defensible decision when the discussion is mature enough.
Current recommendation	Optional, revisable indication of where you are leaning right now.

Finding review in progress

Session #4 · A1 · etis-framework/comp330-f26-production-acceptance@e973c03a · evidence analysis reused

Complete Review

CURRENTLY COACHING YOU

Elena Torres · Red Team Reviewer

Failure modes · Assumptions · Residual risk

WHAT THE BOARD NOTICED

docs/ai/ai-policy.md, docs/ai/ai-use-log.md, and docs/ai/ai-verification-notes.md are unchanged scaffold. The empty log contains no tool, purpose, artifact, human verification, or resulting action, and the policy does not define permitted use, prohibited use, disclosure expectations, or human ownership.

WHY IT MATTERS

A reviewer cannot determine whether AI-assisted work is acceptable or how accepted output would be made trustworthy and attributable.

YOUR ENGINEERING DECISION

What should the team do now, given what the repository evidence actually supports?

resulting action, and the policy does not define permitted use, prohibited use, disclosure expectations, or human ownership. Start with this: What should the team do now, given what the repository evidence actually supports?

YOU

Stop work, and validate and document charter and scope.

ELENA TORRES · RED TEAM REVIEWER

challenge semantic coaching

SENIOR REVIEWER

Pausing acceptance of AI-assisted work is defensible, but stopping all project work may be broader than this evidence supports. Charter and scope also don't close this specific finding. The immediate action is to define the AI policy, record any AI use—or explicitly record that none occurred—and assign human verification and ownership before accepting affected artifacts. What could go wrong if the team continues accepting work while those controls remain undocumented?

Review is live.

Ask a question, answer the reviewer, disagree, or say you are stuck. Enter sends; Shift+Enter adds a new line.

Talk with Elena

Ask a question, answer what they asked, or think out loud. The reviewer will follow what you mean.

Give me a nudge

Ask the reviewer to reframe or scaffold. If you are truly stuck, they will teach the concept and show you where to review it.

Build my recommendation

Use this when the discussion reaches a real engineering decision. You can keep asking questions first.

What do you recommend right now? (optional)

I am not ready to choose yet

Choose only when the discussion reaches a decision. You can change this as your reasoning develops.

Next engineering move

Explain who or what is affected if the judgment is wrong.

Start shaping your recommendation. It can be rough; the reviewer will coach the next step.

Decision Evidence Consequence Owner Change trigger

0 Team evidence

9 Needs review

Frozen Snapshot

EV-001

README.md

A reviewer can understand the project, current direction, and evidence map.

FACT TEAM ADAPTED CURRENT PHASE

A1 expected evidence

Ask about this Reference Open

EV-002

docs/team/team-charter.md

Team purpose, cadence, expectations, and operating rhythm are explicit.

FACT BASELINE CURRENT PHASE

A1 expected evidence

Ask about this Reference Open

EV-003

docs/team/roles.md

Student identities, GitHub identities, primary/backup ownership, and acknowledgements are explicit.

RELATED GUIDANCE

Contextual references, not required answers

ES-100

ES-100 — Engineering Principles

Look at ES-100 Engineering Principles, especially governance, escalation, decision rights, and durable evidence.

REVIEW FINDINGS

Snapshot-bound findings · ask, challenge, resolve, or defer

Evidence may be too thin:

README.md

"README.md" exists but appears incomplete or still scaffold-like.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

Open evidence

Scaffold is present but not yet team evidence: docs/team/team-charter.md

"docs/team/team-charter.md" is unchanged from the official COMP 330 starter-kit baseline.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

Open evidence

Scaffold is present but not yet team evidence: docs/team/roles.md

"docs/team/roles.md" is unchanged from the official COMP 330 starter-kit baseline.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

Open evidence

Scaffold is present but not yet team evidence: docs/team/roles.md

"docs/team/roles.md" is unchanged from the official COMP 330 starter-kit baseline.

Discuss Challenge Help me resolve this

Open evidence

Figure 16. Active review: reviewer challenge, evidence rail, coaching modes, current recommendation, next engineering move, and response area. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

10.1 How to talk to the reviewer

- Answer naturally. Grammar, spelling, and accent are not the engineering objective.
- Ask what a term, risk, or consequence means when you do not understand it.
- Say “I don’t know yet” when that is true, then identify what evidence would reduce the uncertainty.
- Challenge the reviewer when it missed evidence or drew the wrong interpretation.
- Name tradeoffs, consequences, constraints, ownership, and the evidence/event that would cause you to change your position.
- Do not optimize for agreement. A well-supported disagreement can show stronger judgment than passive acceptance.

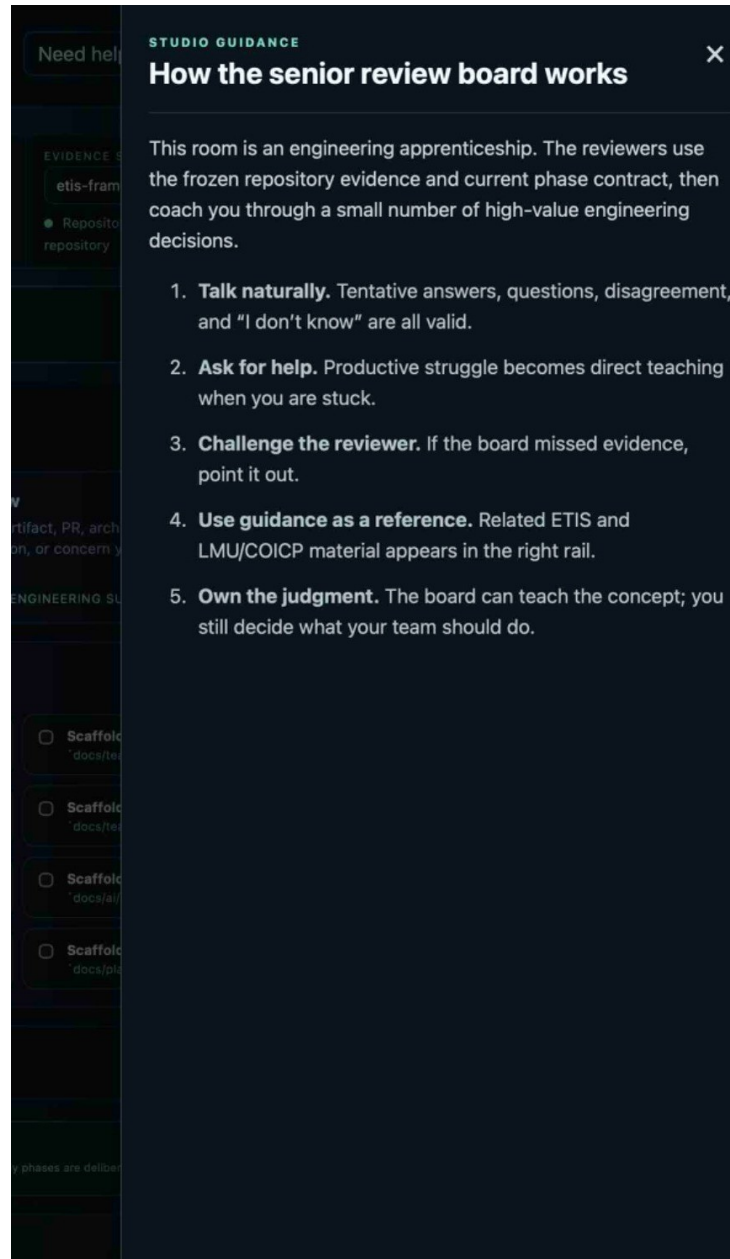


Figure 17. “Need help?” explains the apprenticeship model: talk naturally, ask for help, challenge the reviewer, use guidance as reference, and own the judgment. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

Actions, optional context and keyboard use

Button-triggered instructions are recorded as review actions, not as words the student wrote. Unsent drafts are preserved and remain private. Optional review context and other concerns stay secondary to the current concern and conversation.

In Help, artifact, challenge and exit dialogs, Tab and Shift+Tab stay within the dialog, Escape dismisses through the existing close action, and focus returns to a usable opener. Escape does not finish a review. Closing a pending challenge does not cancel its submitted request.

Use your own words in the composer. A Find supporting evidence action asks the reviewer to search; its generated instructions are not your answer. Open optional review context only when needed. Discuss Recommendation is the send action when you choose recommendation mode, and it does not mean the finding has closed.

11. Recommendations, decisions, and completing a review

11.1 Current recommendation is optional and revisable

Posture	What it communicates
I am not ready to choose yet	There is not enough reasoning/evidence yet for a responsible position.
Continue	Proceed on the current path.
Continue with conditions	Proceed only within explicit conditions/boundaries.
Hold / defer	Pause the relevant decision/work until uncertainty or evidence is reduced.
Reject this path	Recommend a different direction.
Request evidence / escalate	The decision cannot responsibly be made at the current evidence or authority level.

Your current recommendation changes how the reviewer challenges you. It is not automatically your final commitment. You may change it as the discussion develops.

The screenshot displays the ETIS Engineering Studio interface. At the top, there are three tabs: 'use-log.md, and docs/ai-verification-notes.md are unchanged scaffold. The empty log contains no tool, purpose, artifact, human verification, or resulting action, and the policy does not define permitted use, prohibited use, disclosure expectations, or human ownership.', 'work is acceptable or how accepted output would be made trustworthy and attributable.', and 'repository evidence actually supports?'. Below these tabs, a text area contains the text: 'decision rights yet. Does your charter or roles record explicitly authorize the team leader, or is that assignment still something the team must document?'. Below this text area, a button labeled 'YOU' is visible. To the right of the button, a text area contains the text: 'My decision is to hold until we reconcile these issues and build into evidence'. Below this text area, a button labeled 'ELENA TORRES - RED TEAM REVIEWER' is visible. To the right of the button, a text area contains the text: 'That's a defensible decision. Tighten the hold so it matches the evidence: pause **acceptance of AI-assisted artifacts**, rather than all project work, until the team documents the policy, decision rights, use history or explicit non-use, and human verification. The hold can be lifted when those records are reviewed and approved by the authorized team role. Is that the boundary you intend, or are you proposing to hold all project work?'. Below this text area, a button labeled 'Review is live. Ask a question, answer the reviewer, disagree, or say you are stuck. Enter sends; Shift+Enter adds a new line.' is visible. To the right of the button, a text area contains the text: 'What do you recommend right now? (optional) Hold / defer'. Below this text area, a button labeled 'Next engineering move' is visible. To the right of the button, a text area contains the text: 'Clarify what may continue and what should pause or escalate. Start shaping your recommendation. It can be rough; the reviewer will coach the next step.' Below this text area, a button labeled 'Decision' is visible. To the right of the button, a text area contains the text: 'Enter to discuss - Shift+Enter for newline. Write in your own words. Grammar, spelling, and accent are not being graded. You can answer, ask a question, disagree, or say you are stuck.' Below this text area, a button labeled 'Discuss Recommendation' is visible. To the right of the button, a text area contains the text: 'Evidence'.

On the right side of the interface, there are several sections: 'EV-002 docs/team/team-charter.md' with a 'SCAFFOLD' tag, 'EV-003 docs/team/roles.md' with a 'SCAFFOLD' tag, 'RELATED GUIDANCE' with a link to 'Contextual references, not required answers', 'ES-100 ES-100 — Engineering Principles' with a link to 'Look at ES-100 Engineering Principles, especially governance, escalation, decision rights, and durable evidence.', 'ES-103 EXAMPLE LMU/COICP — Roles and Responsibilities Example' with a link to 'The LMU/COICP Roles and Responsibilities example shows how responsibility and evidence ownership can be made explicit. Use it as an example, not an answer to copy.', 'REVIEW FINDINGS' with a link to 'Snapshot-bound findings - ask, challenge, resolve, or defer', 'Evidence may be too thin: README.md' with a 'REVIEW' tag, 'Scaffold is present but not yet team evidence: docs/team/team-charter.md' with a 'REVIEW' tag, 'Scaffold is present but not yet team evidence: docs/team/roles.md' with a 'REVIEW' tag, and 'Scaffold is present but not yet team evidence: docs/team/working-agreements.md' with a 'REVIEW' tag. Each of these sections has a 'Discuss' button and a 'Help me resolve this' button.

Figure 18. Example of a developing position: “Hold / defer.” The reviewer narrows the boundary so the student can make a more defensible decision. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

11.2 Building and recording a recommendation

Use Build my recommendation to choose the coaching mode. Discuss Recommendation sends your message in that mode; it does not record the final position. When the reasoning is ready and a decision is warranted, State My Recommendation records the position you are prepared to defend. Current recommendation remains an optional posture. None of these actions is Git submission, grading or automatic finding closure.

11.3 Complete Review

Complete Review closes the current developmental session and preserves its persisted turns and frozen evidence context. Completion is not a grade. If the repository changes later and you need a clean new context, start a new review rather than trying to rewrite the old one.

12. Findings, challenges, corrections, and follow-up

Action	Use it when	What good use looks like
Discuss	You want to understand the finding and its consequence.	Ask what evidence caused it, what risk it implies, and what would close it.
Challenge	You believe the interpretation is wrong or incomplete.	Point to contrary evidence or explain the engineering rationale; do not simply say "AI is wrong."
Help me resolve this	The finding is reasonable but you need a path forward.	Use coaching to identify the next evidence/work, owner, and closure condition.
Accept / defer	You agree or intentionally postpone it.	State why, the consequence you are accepting, and the condition/date/evidence for revisit.
Correction / staff disposition	The finding was a false REVIEW interpretation and is validated as such.	The correction prevents rediscovery on the same snapshot without mutating the underlying FACT evidence.

FACT VS. REVIEW

FACT is frozen repository-derived evidence. REVIEW is an interpretation of FACT. A review finding can be challenged or corrected; the frozen evidence itself is not rewritten to make the conversation look cleaner.

How a finding actually closes

Only authoritative corrected or resolved findings are closed. Confirmed, evidence disputed, accepted risk and deferred findings remain open. Inspecting, searching, recommending and completing a review do not close a finding; work after the snapshot cannot close it on that earlier snapshot.

Challenge a false finding with counterevidence that already existed in the frozen snapshot. Explain its engineering meaning, not only its filename. Missing or bounded search results do not prove that no equivalent evidence exists. If your fix was committed later, start a review that captures the new repository state.

13. Review History and revisiting older work

Review History is your cumulative learning record. It lists sessions by phase/session number, date/time, completion state, and position-development state. Your conversations are individual, but each session remains tied to the frozen team evidence used at that moment.

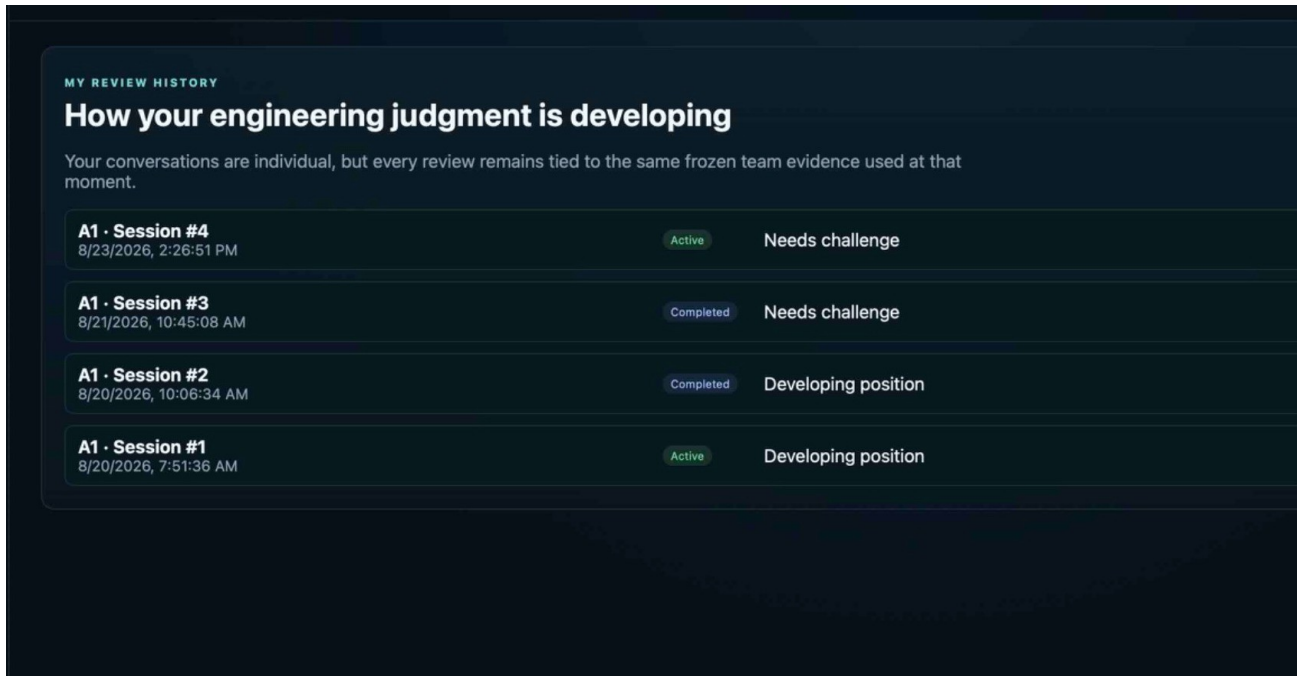


Figure 19. Review History preserves multiple sessions over time. Active and completed sessions can coexist. Historical reference figure; current text governs.

1. Open Review History.
2. Choose the session you want to revisit.
3. If the session is active, return to it when you want to continue that same frozen-context conversation.
4. If the session is completed, treat it as read-only history against its original frozen evidence snapshot. Use it to remember what you knew, what you recommended, and what evidence existed then.
5. If the team has materially changed the repository and you want those changes reviewed, start a new review for the newer evidence state rather than trying to rewrite the old historical session.

Your goal	Use this path
Continue the same conversation	Open the active session from Engineering Studio or Review History. It remains tied to the same frozen snapshot.
See what you previously reasoned	Open the older session in Review History and compare its reasoning/position with what you know now.
Get feedback on new commits	Start a new review so the Studio freezes and analyzes a newer evidence snapshot.
See the exact code/commit diff	Use GitHub commit, branch, pull-request, or tag history; ETIS Review History is the engineering-conversation record, not a replacement Git browser.

WHY OLD REVIEWS STAY OLD

Historical integrity is intentional. A strong engineering record shows what was known and decided at the time, not a retroactively cleaned-up version after later commits solved the problem.

14. What happens after new commits and later checkpoints

Situation	What to do
Team pushes commits while my review is active	Continue the current review against its frozen snapshot. The new commits do not silently change the evidence under the conversation.
We fixed issues after the review	Commit/push the changes in GitHub. When you need the Studio to evaluate the newer state, start a later review so a new evidence snapshot is frozen.
I want to compare “before” and “after”	Use GitHub to inspect exact commit/PR history, then compare the older Review History session/snapshot with the newer review and its evidence context.
I need to prove a formal phase-gate boundary	Follow the course's required designated Git tag/formal evidence procedure. Studio developmental review is not itself the formal evidence boundary.
A finding was wrong on the old snapshot	Challenge/correct the REVIEW interpretation. Do not mutate FACT evidence or pretend later commits were present earlier.

15. Help, privacy, team-shared vs. individual state

15.1 Help & guidance

Use Need help? / Help & guidance when you are unsure how to engage the board. Related ETIS and course/reference guidance may also appear in the right rail. Guidance is contextual reference, not a required answer to copy.

15.2 What instructors can see

- Teaching staff can inspect persisted review turns when authorized.
- Unsent drafts remain private.
- Instructor visibility is for coaching/oversight; generic read authority does not let staff impersonate your student review actions.
- AI usage telemetry is bounded operational metadata; it is not a transcript dump and is not an automated grade.

15.3 Shared and individual data

Team-shared	Individual
Verified repository binding	Your review conversations
Frozen team evidence snapshots	Your developing recommendation/position
Team membership and project context	Your personal review history/learning state
Repository-derived strengths/findings	Your GitHub identity link

16. Student troubleshooting

Problem	What to check/do
I can sign in but cannot enter the course	Authentication is not course authorization. Confirm you are on the active roster/section and contact the instructor if the assignment is wrong.
Wrong GitHub account is linked	My Team -> Change linked GitHub account -> choose the intended engineering account.
Repository says owner authorization required	The personal owner or GitHub organization owner/admin must authorize the App. Non-owners should wait.
GitHub App shows repository selection	Choose Only select repositories and only the nominated repository. Never choose All repositories.
Step 1 is complete but repository is not verified	Return to My Team and choose Check & verify repository access.
Verification fails	Confirm the App installation includes the exact nominated repository and uses selected-repository scope. Do not keep nominating random URLs.
Verified repository must change	Ask the instructor/course owner to Reset repository onboarding. Students cannot directly replace a verified binding.
Evidence is 0%/thin	Check whether the repo mostly contains starter scaffold. Look for team-created project-specific evidence and equivalent artifacts.
Finding seems wrong	Use Challenge and point to evidence. For an existing finding, use Review Findings.
I am stuck in the conversation	Ask a question or use Give me a nudge. You are allowed to say what you do not know yet.
Review is using old evidence	That may be correct: an active/completed session is frozen. Start a new review for newer repository evidence.
Page is repeatedly slow	Wait/retry once; if persistent, capture browser Network timings/request IDs if available and report the slow request to the instructor.
Logout/sign-in seems odd	Log out, close stale tabs if needed, and sign in again. Your persisted GitHub/team/review records are not erased by logout.

17. Appendix A - Student use cases

Normal A1 Board Review

When: Repository is verified and the team wants phase-aware developmental review.

Recommended path: Inspect Engineering Evidence -> choose Board Review -> start review -> reason/ask/challenge -> state recommendation only when warranted -> Complete Review -> commit follow-up changes in GitHub.

Specific architecture concern

When: You are deciding whether to use a database, auth pattern, deployment design, API boundary, etc.

Recommended path: Choose Focused Review, name the decision/artifact, bring the relevant evidence, and ask the board to stress the tradeoff rather than asking “is this good?”

Reviewer missed evidence

When: The finding says an artifact is missing, but the repo contains equivalent evidence.

Recommended path: Use Challenge; reference the path/PR/decision record and explain why it serves the engineering purpose. Seek correction if the interpretation is demonstrably false.

Team changed the repository after a completed review

When: The old review still shows missing/weak evidence.

Recommended path: Leave the old review intact. Use GitHub to verify the new commits, then start a new review so a new snapshot captures the improved state.

Organization repository approval pending

When: Student cannot complete Step 1 immediately.

Recommended path: Use GitHub’s organization request flow. Wait for an owner/admin with GitHub authority; then return and complete Step 2 verification.

Not ready to decide

When: The reviewer asks for a recommendation but key evidence is missing.

Recommended path: Keep “I am not ready to choose yet” or Request evidence/escalate. State exactly what evidence/authority is needed and who owns obtaining it.

Responsible hold

When: Risk is high enough that work/acceptance should pause.

Recommended path: Choose Hold/defer, narrow what is actually paused, name the condition for lifting the hold, and avoid broader stoppage than the evidence supports.

A teammate already verified the repository

When: You open My Team and the repository is already marked Verified team repository.

Recommended path: Do not nominate or authorize another repository. Verify that it is the correct team repository, then continue to Engineering Evidence/Studio. Repository trust is team-shared.

You return after a break and see an Active session

When: Review History or Engineering Studio shows an existing active review.

Recommended path: Resume it if you want the same frozen-context conversation. Start a new review only when you intentionally want a new review purpose or newer evidence snapshot.

You need evidence from a different file or artifact

When: A finding references one path, but the engineering purpose is satisfied elsewhere.

Recommended path: Use Open/Inspect/Ask the Board/Challenge as available, point to the equivalent artifact, and explain why it satisfies the engineering purpose rather than merely having a similar filename.

18. Appendix B - Strong engineering response checklist

- What do I recommend right now - or why am I not ready to recommend?
- What repository evidence supports that position?
- What important uncertainty/evidence boundary remains?
- What consequence or residual risk am I accepting?
- What condition, constraint, or guardrail limits the decision?
- Who owns the follow-up?
- What evidence/event would cause me to change, lift, reject, or close the decision?
- If the reviewer disagrees, can I explain the tradeoff instead of simply repeating my preference?

19. Appendix C - Snapshot, commit, and history FAQ

Question	Answer
Is a snapshot the same as a Git commit?	A snapshot is ETIS's frozen evidence package for a review. It is anchored in a repository state and provenance such as commit/ref information, but it can also contain bounded metadata from issues, PRs, Actions, tags, branches, and other repository signals. GitHub remains authoritative for the raw commit history.
When is the checkpoint created?	When a review begins. The UI explicitly says beginning a review freezes the current evidence snapshot.
Can I refresh an active review to the newest commits?	Not by rewriting the existing snapshot. Finish/leave the historical session intact and start a later review for a new snapshot.
Why does Review History show an older problem after we fixed it?	Because it is a truthful historical record of the evidence and reasoning at that time.
How do I inspect old code exactly?	Use GitHub commit/branch/tag history. Use ETIS Review History to inspect the old engineering conversation and snapshot context.
Does the Studio's checkpoint replace the formal phase-gate tag?	No. The Studio checkpoint is developmental review evidence. Follow the course's designated Git-tag/formal evidence process for formal review.

20. Appendix D - Terminology

Term	Student meaning
FACT	Immutable repository-derived evidence frozen for a review.
REVIEW	Interpretation of FACT evidence; may be challenged/corrected.
Candidate repository	Nominated URL that is not yet trusted.

Term	Student meaning
Verified team repository	Exact repository verified through the GitHub App and shared by the team.
Evidence snapshot / checkpoint	Frozen evidence package used by a particular review.
Current recommendation	Optional and revisable decision posture.
Discuss Recommendation	Send action in recommendation mode; State My Recommendation separately records a defensible position.
Review History	Your persisted sessions tied to the frozen evidence that existed at the time.
Equivalent evidence	Project-specific artifact that serves the required engineering purpose even if its form/name differs.
Starter scaffold	Provided structure/examples that do not by themselves prove the team performed the engineering work.